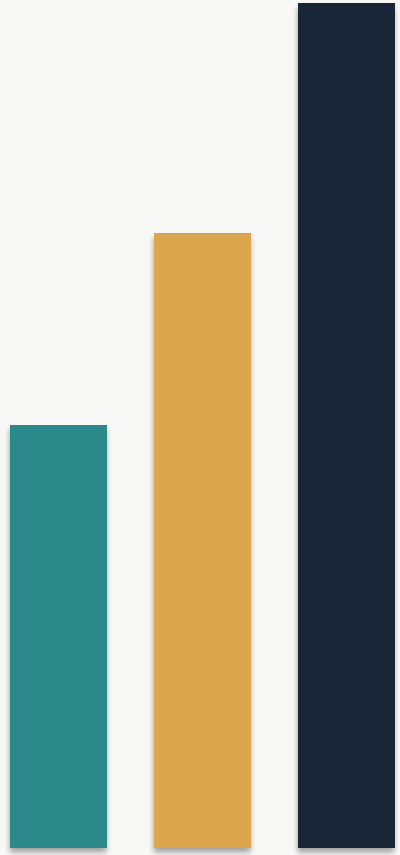
LOS ANGELES · MARKET STUDY

A cafe designed

to scale.

Market evidence for a cafe with robot waiters:
where the opportunity is, what the unit should look like,
and why the concept can become a replicable format.



LUCIANA JOST

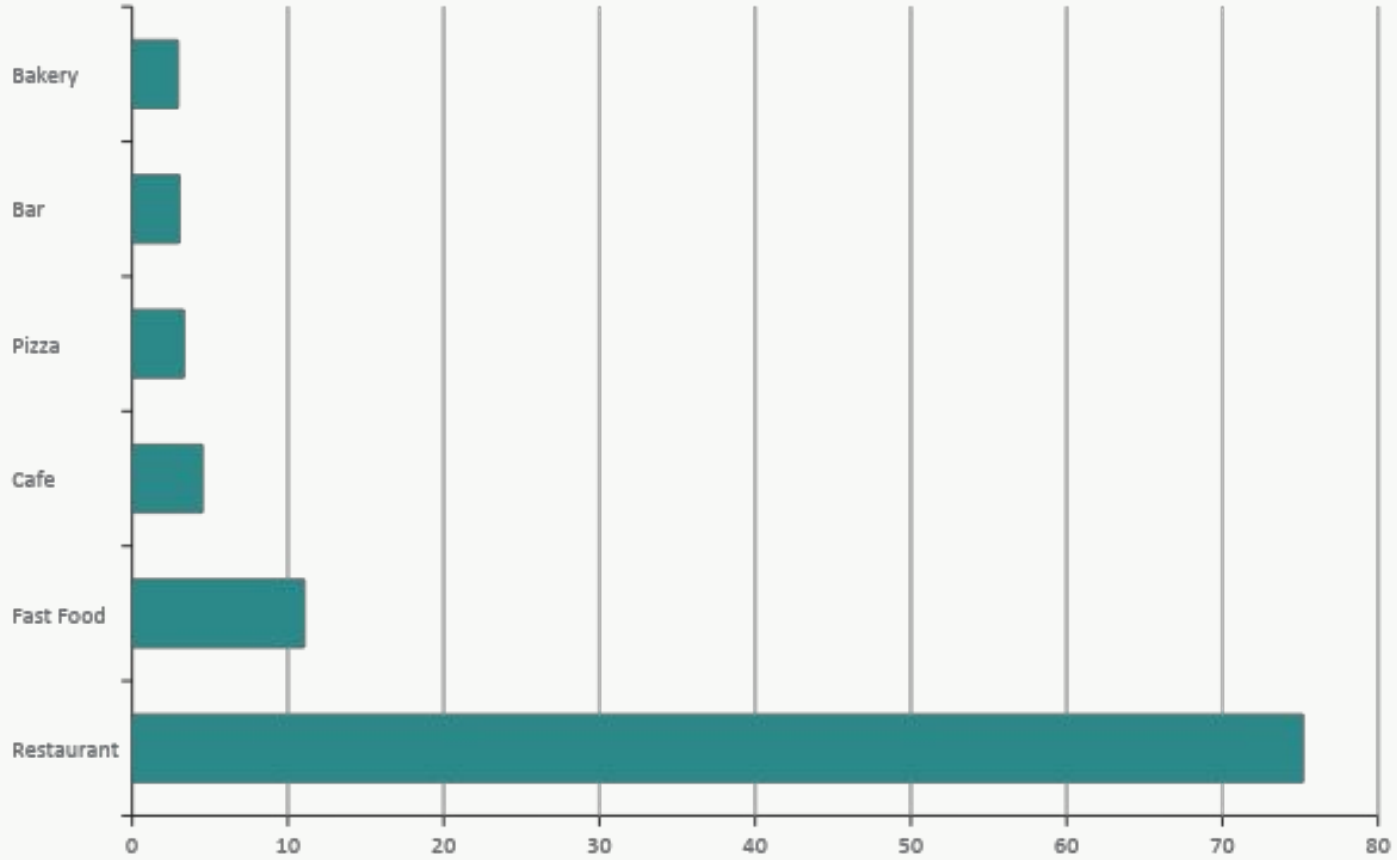
Data Analytics Certification · TripleTen

The market is large and concentrated in restaurants

9,650

establishments in the dataset

Restaurants make up 75.2% of the market. Cafes are only 4.5%, a smaller category where a differentiated concept can stand out.



FOR THE INVESTOR

Small category ≠ small opportunity.
It means positioning matters.

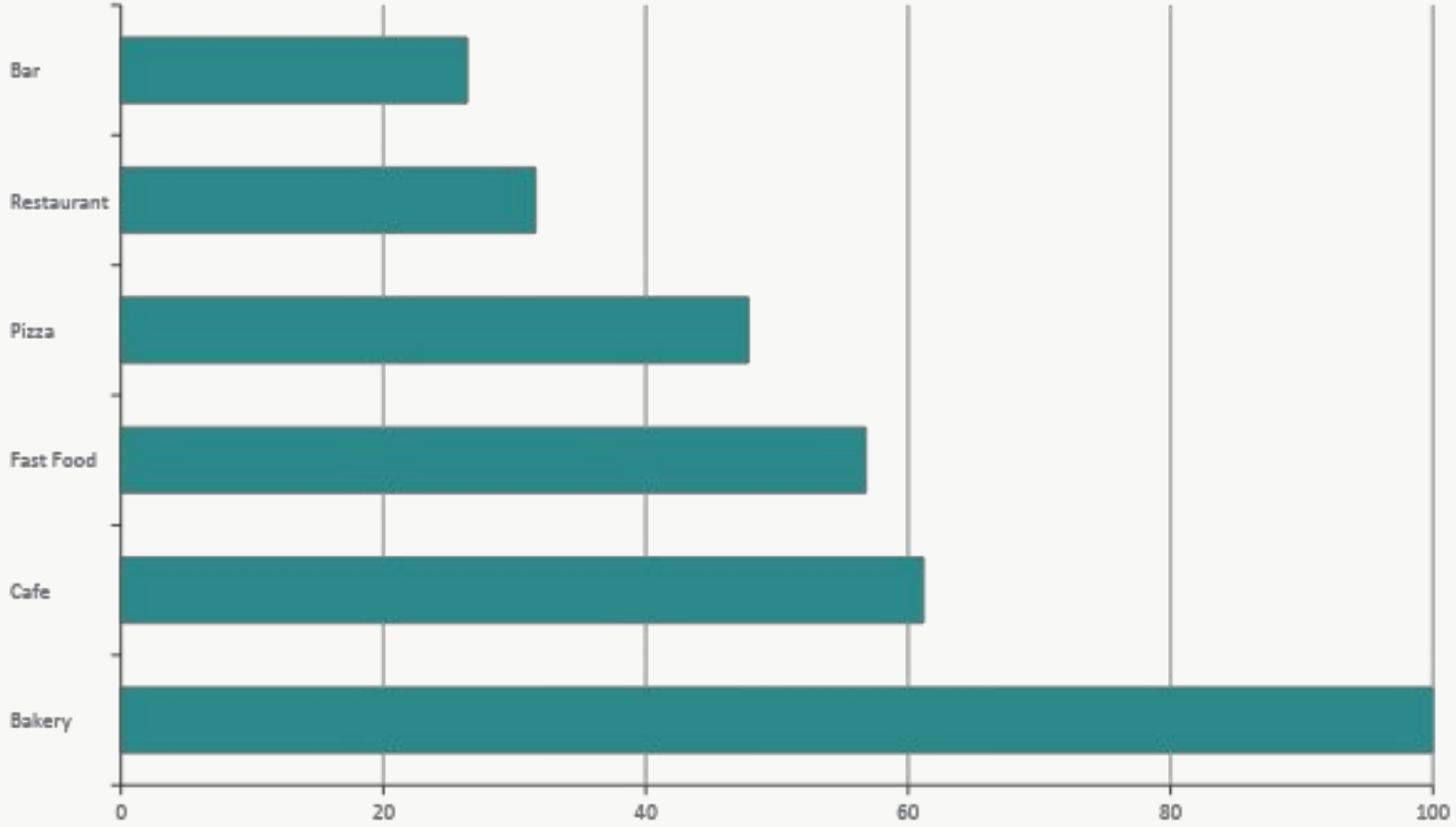
Cafes show strong potential for a chain model

61.1%

of cafes are
chain establishments

The cafe category already shows a strong precedent for replication.

This suggests a standardized service concept, including robot service, can be structured to expand across different locations.



The data points to a compact format of 25 to 30 seats

25

average seats per cafe

48.0

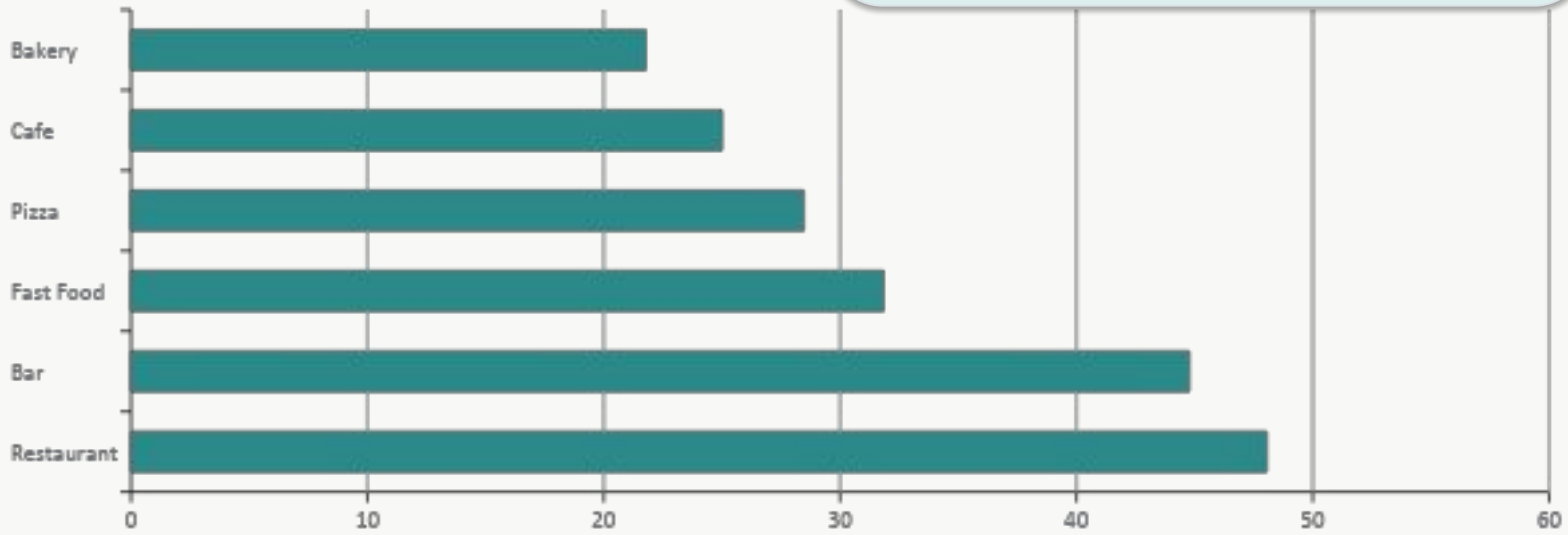
average seats per restaurant

RECOMMENDED STARTING POINT

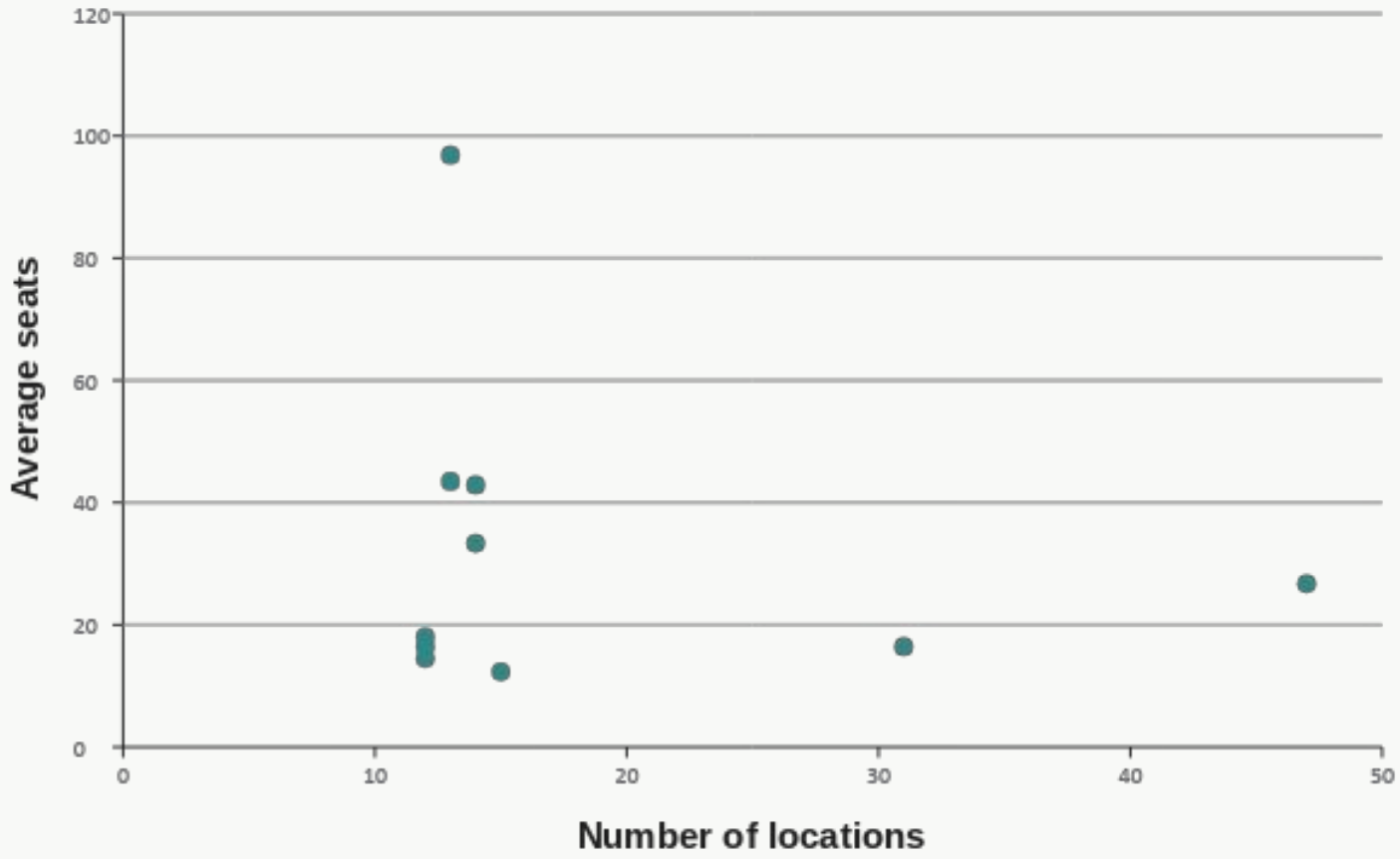
25–30 seats

Why smaller matters

A moderate space reduces the risk of designing a first unit that is too large and supports a replicable operating model.



The largest chains in the sample generally operate compact units



THE SIGNAL

47 locations

The Coffee Bean & Tea Leaf

26.7 average seats per location

A scalable concept does not need a large space in every location.

Source: the 10 largest chains identified in the analysis.

Restaurant density creates visibility, and also competition



381

restaurants on WILSHIRE BLVD

340 streets

have only one restaurant

The implication is strategic: the highest concentration of restaurants does not automatically mean the best location. The choice must balance visibility, competition and operating cost.

High-density corridors are not dominated by large establishments

On the ten streets with the most restaurants, most establishments have moderate capacity, while a smaller share has a significantly higher number of seats.

WHAT THE DISTRIBUTION SHOWS

Moderate capacity is the norm. Large establishments are the exception.

This supports the 25 to 30 seat recommendation: the concept can compete in dense corridors without the space of a large restaurant.

FOR THE INVESTOR

Design the first unit as a model, not as a monument.

The data points to a compact, replicable format. The differentiator can attract customers, but the model must keep operations efficient and sustainable.

Four signals show the concept is worth testing

01

CATEGORY FIT

61.1% of cafes in the dataset are already chains.

02

RIGHT UNIT SIZE

25 to 30 seats is in line with the cafe benchmark.

03

REPLICABLE FORMAT

The largest chains in the sample generally run units of moderate capacity.

04

LOCATION DIVERSITY

There are highly concentrated corridors, but also **340 streets with only one restaurant** .

CASE · Prove one efficient unit, then replicate the format.

THE RECOMMENDATION

Start small.

Design to scale.

Build around 25 to 30 seats, use robot service as an experience differentiator, and treat the first unit as the chain's operating model.

The data supports the format. Execution will determine whether the novelty becomes a lasting advantage.

LUCIANA JOST

Data Analytics Certification · TripleTen